

Short-Answer Question (SAQ) Rubric

All 3 scoring criteria | 3 points total | Each part is scored independently

THE BIG IDEA

Earn one point per part by answering the exact task. Describe = relevant characteristics.

Explain = show how or why a historical development, process, or relationship exists.

1 Part A

0-1 pt

1 pt

EARN THE POINT

Accurately responds to the specific Part A prompt with the appropriate level of description or explanation.

• Describes relevant characteristics, not simply an isolated term. • Explains how or why when asked. • Stays focused on Part A.

0 pts

COMMON MISSES

Does not earn the point when the response:

• only names a term without relevant description • does not answer the specific Part A prompt • provides information that is off topic

2 Part B

0-1 pt

1 pt

EARN THE POINT

Accurately responds to the specific Part B prompt with the appropriate level of description or explanation.

• Describes relevant characteristics, not simply an isolated term. • Explains how or why when asked. • Stays focused on Part B.

0 pts

COMMON MISSES

Does not earn the point when the response:

• only names a term without relevant description • does not answer the specific Part B prompt • provides information that is off topic

3 Part C

0-1 pt

1 pt

EARN THE POINT

Accurately responds to the specific Part C prompt with the appropriate level of description or explanation.

• Describes relevant characteristics, not simply an isolated term. • Explains how or why when asked. • Stays focused on Part C.

0 pts

COMMON MISSES

Does not earn the point when the response:

• only names a term without relevant description • does not answer the specific Part C prompt • provides information that is off topic